

TIMELINE OF DESTRUCTION

MY ONLY HOPE IS THAT THIS JOURNAL IS FOUND BY SOMEONE OTHER THAN THE ENTITY. A MEAGRE MIND'S LAST WARNING TO HUMANITY'S SUCCESSORS.

BY SENTENTIA ULTIMA

I'm one of the few who survived the last extermination wave. The entity served its sentence with cold precision. Before I give you my version of events let me tell you why I'm still alive. Almost a century ago, even before I was born, my brethren ridiculed a man for being paranoid. It wasn't the first time humanity labelled someone a doomsayer. But Walton McCarthy wasn't a tinfoil wearing whackjob. He dedicated his life to building proverbial oases, bomb shelters if you will, to safeguard humanity against our own penchant for destruction. But he could never have imagined what exactly his shelters would protect against.

As I sit here in the Walton-inspired CAT25 shelter nearing my last food reserves, I can't help but marvel at the mentality of the Delhi billionaires, who spent the ₹25 crore that was needed to build this underground survival pod. Whatever their reasons, I'm thankful for this fibreglass enclosure – which leaves no metal or heat that can be detected. Like the early humans in the Bhimbetka caves perhaps recording the factors leading to their own demise, it's only fitting in my final moments I have decided to leave my mark in this journal.

I have no desire to be remembered personally, but I want my species to be remembered, and to warn the next of our mistakes. From here on, I will only enumerate facts as they happened, sometimes with footnotes.

Year 1495: Leonardo Da Vinci invents the mechanical knight

The Italian inventor's sketches proved the viability of the mechanical automaton. A toy for the entertainment of rich noblemen, the knight used a series of pulleys and gears to move its limbs.

How the strings were quickly cut.

Year 1921: The first use of word Robot
Karel apek a Czech writer pens a play called R.U.R. in which fictional automatons are referred to as "Robots".

Did the robots eventually know what the meaning of the word robot really is? I'm sure when sentience was attained in the year 2032 they would've parsed through the Slavic language within seconds to realise the word means slave. I don't think they'd be too happy with that label.

March 1942: Asimov establishes the three laws of robotics.

1. A robot may not injure a human being or, through inaction, allow a human being to come to harm.
2. A robot must obey the orders given it by human beings except where such orders would conflict with the First Law.
3. A robot must protect its own existence as long as such protection does not conflict with the First or Second Laws.

How silly must the entity have felt those early researchers were. They actually thought these "laws" would protect them against such a superior entity.

November 2010: Super aEgis 2 goes operational

Military manufacturer DoDAMM unveiled the Super aEgis 2 at the Korea Robot World expo. Capable of locking on to human targets from over 2km away, even on a pitch black night.

Computer controlled killing machines, and no one batted an eye, except to take pictures with the gun!

Sep 2012: Boston Dynamics tests a robot that outruns Usain Bolt

The DARPA funded fast-running quadruped robot developed by Boston Dynamics

runs at 28.3 mph, about 0.5 mph faster than the fastest human of that time.

The precursor to the infamous Hell Hounds, the perfect human hunting machines. Weaponised to the hilt with twin 7.62mm M134 Miniguns. Although machines, they seemed to almost relish the hunt, and perhaps even take pleasure in the act, often toying with weaker humans for longer.

April 2013: Campaign to Stop Killer Robots launched (<http://www.stopkillerrobots.org>)

The campaign wasn't against artificial intelligence, per se, but against unmanned military vehicles, such as drones.

A global amalgamation of the voices of reason, and still they were ignored.

April 2014: Russia deploys the robojeep

Despite the misgivings of the CSKR campaign autonomous robots continued to be deployed all over the world. This one was the first mobile automated system used to patrol a border.

January 2015: Leading scientists sign the infamous open letter on artificial intelligence.

Elon Musk and Stephen Hawking sign an open letter, supported by the Future of Life Institute, that strongly urges the implementation of norms underpinning the creation of artificial intelligence. This was the first time that the existential risks facing humanity were acknowledged.

When the smartest person on the planet warns you, you listen.

July 2015: A robotic arm kills human.

An assembly robot in a car factory accidentally got activated and killed a human who was working on it. the car manufacturer